

Unit 5: General Principles of Chemistry II – Transition Metals and Organic Nitrogen Chemistry

Topics 5.3 – Redox and the chemistry of the transition metals

The study of chemical cells provides an opportunity to illustrate the impact on scientific thinking when it emerges that ideas developed in different contexts can be shown to be related to a major explanatory principle. In this unit, cell emfs and equilibrium constants are shown to be related to the fundamental criterion for the feasibility of a chemical reaction: the total entropy change.

5.3.1c	Students need to understand that electrode potentials are relative and therefore some reference point is needed to classify the data. Hence the need for a standard reference electrode.
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HSW 1